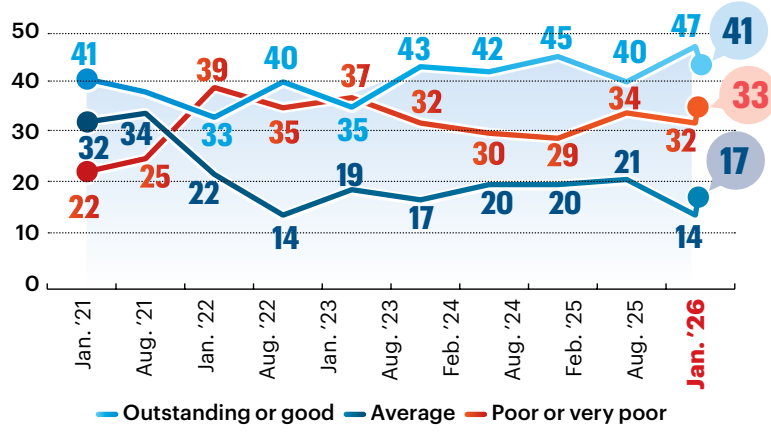
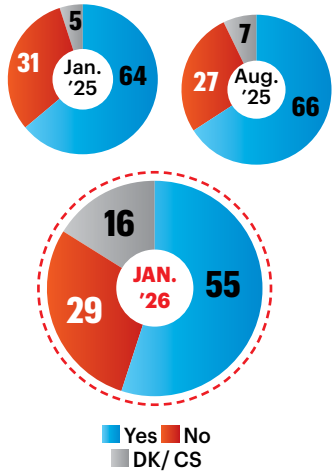
Q. How would you rate the performance of the Congress as an Opposition party?

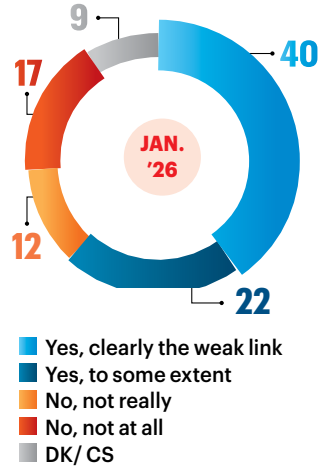


Q. Do you think the Congress is the real Opposition party?



Congress's stock as the main Opposition party takes a big hit

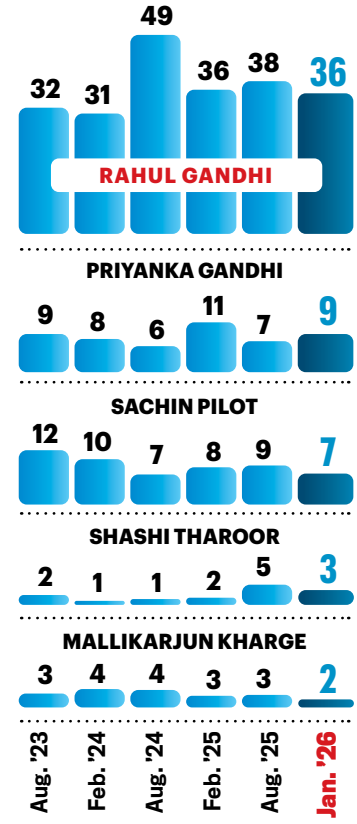
Q. Do you think the Congress is the weak link in the I.N.D.I.A. bloc?



Recent poll results have reinforced this perception about the Congress

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/CS: Don't know/can't say

Q. Which Congress leader is best suited to lead the party?



altered the internal arithmetic of the INDIA bloc. Over 62 per cent of the respondents now believe the Congress is the weak link in the alliance.

The Opposition now enters a crucial phase. This year will test its capacity to fight and hold ground in poll-bound big states—Assam, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu and Kerala—where organisation, alliance management and leadership clarity will matter more than rhetoric.

PROBLEMS APLENTY

In Tamil Nadu, the Congress-DMK alliance has long been a stable relationship, but now younger leaders argue for an alliance 'reset', saying the party risks becoming electorally irrelevant. In Kerala, the Congress faces the Left—its national ally—which, under Pinarayi Vijayan, is seeking a consecutive third term. Yet, the Congress enters the contest weighed down by factionalism, struggling to convert anti-incumbency into a credible poll alternative. In Assam, the Congress has Gaurav Gogoi as state president. He represents generational change, parliamentary credibility and a clean public image. But the party remains organisationally weak and strategically confused. West Bengal presents perhaps the most paradoxical test for the INDIA bloc. CM Mamata Banerjee is locked in a high-stakes contest with a BJP that has expanded its organisational footprint and sharpened its polarising narrative. Yet the Opposition's national promise of unity fractures sharply here.

These strands together explain the broader mood captured by the January 2026 MOTN. The electorate appears to be sending a precise message: critique alone is not enough, and proclamations of unity alone do not lend credibility. Until the Opposition resolves these gaps, it may well stay peripheral to the national narrative. ■